CCC-C-001375A (GSA-FSS)
November 28, 1975
SUPERSEDING
Int.Fed.Spec. CCC-C-001375(GSA-FSS)
August 15, 1967

# INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

## CLOTH, WAFFLE, COTTON

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

### 1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers cotton waffle weave cloth furnished in rolls or bolts and used primarily for the fabrication of dishwashing, dusting, and scrubbing cloths.

1.2 Classification. Cloth of one type and grade shall be furnished in rolls or bolts, in the following widths, as specified (see 6.2):

28-inch width
36-inch width

### 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

PPP-P-1134 - Packaging and Packing of Cotton and Cotton-Synthetic Fiber Blend Fabrics (Excluding Duck Fabrics).

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 4 - Glossary of Fabric Imperfections.
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks, and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards, from established distribution points in their agencies.)



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Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

16 CFR 303 - Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

(Copies may be obtained without charge from the Federal Trade Commission, Washington, DC 20580.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, NW., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Yarn. Yarn shall be made from cotton of a suitable grade and staple length which has been thoroughly cleaned, well carded, evenly drawn, and plied as specified in table I.

3.2 Weave. The cloth shall be woven with a honeycomb weave (dobby).

3.3 Physical requirements. The finished cloth shall conform to the requirements shown in table I.

TABLE I. Physical requirements

| Weight per square yard (minimum) | Yarns per inch (minimum) | | Ply (minimum) | | Breaking strength grab method (minimum) | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Warp | Filling | Warp | Filling | Warp | Filling |
| | | | | | Pounds | Pounds |
| Ounces 6.5 | 37 | 24 | 2 | 2 | 55 | 45 |

3.4 Width. Cloth shall be 28 or 36 inches in width inclusive of selvages, and shall have a tolerance of plus or minus 1/2 inch.

3.5 Length. Unless otherwise specified, rolls or bolts shall be in lengths of 100 yards, plus or minus 10 yards. No piece shall be less than 1 yard in length and no roll or bolt shall contain more than 10 pieces measuring the minimum of 1 yard. Each roll or bolt shall be put-up as specified in PPP-P-1134.

3.6 Fiber identification. Each roll, bolt, or piece of finished cloth shall be labeled, ticketed, or invoiced for fiber content in accordance with the Rules and Regulations under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.



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3.7 Absorbency. The cloth shall be considered absorbent to water when meeting the requirements of test specified in 4.4.1.

3.8 Finish. Unless otherwise specified, the finished cloth shall be unshrunk, and unbleached or bleached.

3.9 Workmanship. The finished cloth shall conform to the quality established by the specification. The demerit points per 100 square yards, when calculated as specified in section 4, shall not exceed the established maximum point value.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Examination of the end item. Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with the provisions of MIL-STD-105, and 4.2.1 through 4.2.3.

4.2.1 Yard-by-yard examination. The required yardage of each roll or bolt shall be examined on both sides, and all defects, as defined in section 1 of Fed. Std. No. 4, which are clearly noticeable at normal inspection distance (3 feet), shall be scored and assigned demerit points as listed in 4.2.1.1. Discoloration, foreign matter, leaf motes, or neppiness to the degree normally expected when tinged or spotted cotton is used shall not be scored. None of the 30 continuous linear yards, or increments of 1 yard on the measuring device of the inspection machine, selected for examination from any one roll or bolt within the sample, shall be penalized more than four points. The sample unit for this examination shall be 1 linear yard. The sample size shall be 450 linear yards, regardless of lot size. The sample yardage shall be examined from 15 rolls taken from 15 containers. An approximately equal number of yards shall be examined in each roll or bolt in the sample. The lot shall be unacceptable if the points per hundred square yards exceed 60.00. Point computation shall be as follows:

4.2.1.1 Demerit points. Demerit points shall be assigned as follows:

| | |
|---|---|
| For defects up to 3 inches in any dimension | 1 point |
| For defects exceeding 3 inches, but not exceeding 6 inches in any dimension | 2 points |
| For defects exceeding 6 inches, but not exceeding 9 inches in any dimension | 3 points |
| For defects exceeding 9 inches in any dimension | 4 points |

NOTE: The following defects, when present, shall be scored four points for each yard in which they occur:

Width less than minimum specified.
Objectionable odor.

4.2.2 Examination for length.

4.2.2.1 Individual rolls or bolts. During the yard-by-yard examination, each roll or bolt in the sample shall be examined for length. Any length found to be less than the minimum specified, or more than 2 yards below the length marked on the ticket, shall be considered a defect with respect to length. The lot shall be unacceptable if two or more rolls or bolts in the sample are defective in respect to length.



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4.2.2.2 Total yardage in sample. The lot shall be unacceptable if the total of the actual lengths of rolls or bolts in the sample is less than the total of the lengths marked on the tickets.

4.2.3 Examination for compliance with Textile Fiber Products Identification Act. During the yard-by-yard examination, each roll or bolt in the sample shall be examined for compliance with the Rules and Regulations under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act. Each roll or bolt not labeled in accordance with this act shall be a defect. The lot shall be unacceptable if two or more of these defects occur.

4.3 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the applicable requirements of PPP-P-1134.

| Examine | Defects |
|---|---|
| Markings (exterior and interior) | Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application. |
| Materials | Any component missing or damaged. |
| Workmanship | Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Distortion of container. |
| Contents (exterior and interior container) | Number per container is more or less than required. Net weight exceeds requirements. |

4.4 Testing of the end item. The methods of testing specified in Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191, wherever applicable, and as listed in tables I and II, shall be followed. The physical and chemical values specified in section 3 apply to the average of the determination made on a sample unit for test purposes as specified in the applicable test method, or as indicated in table II. The sample unit shall be 1 yard, full width, of the finished cloth. The sample size shall be in accordance with the following:

| Lot size in yards | Sample size |
|---|---|
| 800 or less | 2 |
| 801 to 22,000 | 3 |
| 22,001 and over | 5 |

TABLE II. Test methods

| Characteristic | Reference 1/ requirement | Test method | No. of determinations per unit of product |
|---|---|---|---|
| Weight | Table I | 5041 | - |
| Yarn, ply | Table I | Visual | 1 |
| Yarns, per inch | Table I | 5050 | 5 |
| Breaking strength | Table I | 5100 | 5 |
| Weave | Par. 3.2 | Visual | 1 |
| Fiber identification | Par. 3.1 | 1200 | 1W - 1F |
| Absorbency | Par. 3.7 | Par. 4.4.1 | 1 |

1/ The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units fail to meet any requirements specified.



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4.4.1 Absorbency test. Wash a 6-inch by 6-inch sample in soap and water by any appropriate washing machine method for not less than 30 minutes, and then dry. The washed, dry sample shall be laid on a flat surface and several drops of water applied. If the water spreads or fans out into the surrounding cloth within 30 seconds, the cloth shall be considered absorbent. If the water is not absorbed, but rolls or otherwise spreads on top of the bloth, the cloth shall be considered nonabsorbent.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Levels A and C. The cloth, put-up as specified, shall be packaged in accordance with the applicable requirements of PPP-P-1134.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Levels A, B, and C. The cloth shall be packed in accordance with the applicable requirements of PPP-P-1134.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipments shall be marked in accordance with the applicable requirements of PPP-P-1134.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Cloth covered by this specification is primarily intended for scrub cloths, dish cloths, and dusting cloths. It can be used for draperies.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Width of cloth (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Whether civil or military marking is required (see 5.3).

6.2.1 In the preparation of contracts or orders, it must be noted that various options, choices, or alternatives, as indicated in PPP-P-1134, may be exercised in the preparation for delivery of cloth.

**Civil Agencies Interest:**

**GSA-FSS**
**AFS**

**Preparing Activity:**

**GSA-FSS**



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